Deutsche Bank
Research

Rating
Buy

North America
United States

Consumer
Retailing / Department Stores & Broadlines

Company
Walmart Inc

Reuters
WMT.OQ

Bloomberg
WMT US

Date
15 October 2026

Rating	Buy
Price target (USD)	136.00
Price at 14 Oct 26	116.16
52-week range	134.20 – 100.61

Valuation & Risks

More Ways to Win, Upgrade to Buy; Takeaways From Our Investor Meetings

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Key changes

Rating	*Hold*	Buy	
Price target (USD)	*113*	136	20%

Source: Deutsche Bank

Our Call: We are upgrading WMT to Buy as we see a more favorable setup into 2027. We believe the current inflationary environment should reinforce WMT's value proposition and support accelerated share gains, while we think investors are starting to increasingly look beyond the headline pressure on U.S. comp. At the same time, we expect incremental margins to improve as higher-margin businesses continue to outgrow core retail and as automation benefits increasingly flow through the P&L. Taken together, we see pricing tailwinds building, market share accelerating, and WMT's flywheel strengthening, while greater disclosure around GMV could increasingly underscore the evolution from traditional retailer to technology-led marketplace.

CFO Meeting Takes: We hosted WMT CFO John David Rainey and the IR team including SVP Steph Wissink and Senior Director Kary Brunner for investor meetings in NYC. Management remains highly confident in the underlying business and long-term algorithm, pointing to some of the strongest food share gains in recent years, continued e-commerce momentum, marketplace expansion, and robust advertising and membership growth. Importantly, consumer trends were characterized as stable to improving vs. 3 months ago, while price gaps remain strong.

We also came away increasingly convinced that **GMV will become a more important lens for evaluating WMT's growth and share gains** as marketplace, advertising, membership, and services become a larger part of the mix. Incremental GMV/ecosystem disclosures could improve visibility into the growth and margin profile of these businesses and potentially support valuation upside.

Lastly, management was constructive on **agentic commerce**, viewing it as more opportunity than disruption given WMT's price leadership, assortment, fulfillment capabilities, and 1P data. Early Sparky results are encouraging, with ~40% larger baskets and higher conversion vs. traditional shopping journeys.

The key meeting discussion points centered around: 1) the core business is stronger than headline metrics imply; **2)** agentic commerce is viewed as an opportunity rather than a threat to the advertising business; **3)** advertising remains one of Walmart's highest-conviction growth drivers; **4)** digital ecosystem margins should ultimately surpass store-level margins; **5)** GMV is becoming a more relevant measure of share gains and business performance; and **6)** elevated

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diesel costs are beginning to flow through to consumer prices, potentially adding 50-100bps of inflation in 2027 if current levels persist. See pages 3-6 for full details.

Price Target of $136

We derive our PT of $136 (prior $113) through a sum of the value of WMT's largest assets: **1)** 39.5x our 2027 EPS estimate (ex. Flipkart), which increases 2.5x and is a premium to the YTD average of 36.7x and **2)** Flipkart based on 4.5x sales (in-line with the acquisition multiple). Our multiple reflects the positive impact of price inflation, ongoing share gains, strong operating income growth, and continued strength in advertising, marketplace, and membership. Upside risks include additional share gains as consumers pursue value, accelerated operating profit expansion, and greater than anticipated benefits from agentic commerce.

Figure 1: WMT Estimate Changes

	Price Target	3Q26E			2026E			2027E		
		Comp Growth	GP Margin %	EPS	Comp Growth	GP Margin %	EPS	Comp Growth	GP Margin %	EPS
Walmart	**$136**	**3.0%/5.0%**	**24.7%**	**$0.65**	**3.0/4.5%**	**24.7%**	**$2.93**	**3.5%/3.9%**	**24.8%**	**$3.32**
Prior Forecast	$113	3.0%/4.0%	24.6%	$0.63	3.0/4.0%	24.6%	$2.91	3.0%/3.5%	24.7%	$3.19
Guidance				*$0.62-$0.64*			*$2.80-$2.87*			
Consensus	$128	2.9%/4.5%	24.3%	$0.64	3.3%/4.3%	24.6%	$2.89	3.5%/4.3%	24.7%	$3.22

Source: Deutsche Bank estimates, Company Filings, Bloomberg Finance LP

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Figure 2: WMT Condensed P&L ($M, except per share data)

	2023	2024	2025	1Q26	2Q26	3Q26E	4Q26E	2026E	2027E
Walmart U.S.	$441,817.0	$462,415.0	$482,975.0	$117,169.0	$125,189.0	$124,478.2	$132,573.9	$499,410.1	$517,501.3
Sam's Club	86,179.0	90,238.0	93,015.0	23,405.0	25,713.0	24,834.4	25,011.0	98,963.3	104,902.0
International	114,641.0	121,885.0	130,423.0	35,110.0	35,198.0	36,865.3	39,721.6	146,894.9	156,596.9
Sales	**642,637.0**	**674,538.0**	**706,413.0**	**175,684.0**	**186,100.0**	**186,177.9**	**197,306.5**	**745,268.4**	**779,000.3**
Net Other Income	5,488.0	6,447.0	6,750.0	2,067.0	1,837.0	1,891.1	1,934.7	7,729.8	8,116.3
Total Revenue	**648,125.0**	**680,985.0**	**713,163.0**	**177,751.0**	**187,937.0**	**188,069.0**	**199,241.2**	**752,998.2**	**787,116.6**
Gross Profit	152,495.0	162,785.0	171,018.0	42,626.0	47,296.0	45,920.6	47,911.7	183,754.3	192,967.3
SG&A	130,878.0	139,549.0	146,695.0	37,200.0	39,750.0	40,287.9	40,486.9	157,724.8	163,952.4
Operating Income	**27,105.0**	**29,683.0**	**31,073.0**	**7,493.0**	**9,383.0**	**7,523.8**	**9,359.5**	**33,759.3**	**37,131.2**
Net Interest Expense	5,164.0	3,039.0	356.0	345.0	1,371.0	691.4	682.2	3,089.6	2,434.0
Pre-Tax Income	**21,941.0**	**26,644.0**	**30,717.0**	**7,148.0**	**8,012.0**	**6,832.4**	**8,677.3**	**30,669.7**	**34,697.2**
Income Tax	5,578.0	6,445.8	7,840.3	1,658.0	1,483.0	1,673.9	2,169.3	6,984.3	8,475.6
Minority Interest	(759.0)	(721.0)	(377.0)	(160.0)	(163.0)	(166.4)	(176.8)	(666.2)	(775.8)
Net Income	**15,511.0**	**19,397.2**	**22,503.7**	**5,330.0**	**6,366.0**	**4,992.1**	**6,331.2**	**23,019.2**	**25,445.7**
Operating EPS	**$2.21**	**$2.50**	**$2.65**	**$0.66**	**$0.81**	**$0.65**	**$0.82**	**$2.93**	**$3.32**
Shares Outstanding (M)	8,108.0	8,081.2	8,020.9	7,999.0	7,978.0	7,733.8	7,716.3	7,855.6	7,675.1
Top-Line Growth									
Walmart U.S. Sales	5.1%	4.7%	4.4%	4.5%	3.5%	3.1%	2.6%	3.4%	3.6%
Walmart U.S. SSS	**5.6%**	**4.5%**	**4.6%**	**4.1%**	**2.6%**	**3.0%**	**2.5%**	**3.0%**	**3.5%**
Sam's Club Sales	2.2%	4.7%	3.1%	6.1%	8.8%	5.5%	5.3%	6.4%	6.0%
Sam's Club SSS	**4.8%**	**5.9%**	**5.1%**	**3.9%**	**4.4%**	**5.0%**	**4.5%**	**4.5%**	**3.9%**
International Sales	13.5%	6.3%	7.0%	18.0%	12.8%	9.9%	10.6%	12.6%	6.6%
Total Revenue	6.0%	5.1%	4.7%	7.3%	5.9%	4.8%	4.5%	5.6%	4.5%
Total SSS	**5.5%**	**4.7%**	**4.6%**	**4.1%**	**2.9%**	**3.3%**	**2.8%**	**3.2%**	**3.6%**
Margin Analysis									
Gross Profit	23.7%	24.1%	24.2%	24.3%	25.4%	24.7%	24.3%	24.7%	24.8%
SG&A	20.4%	20.7%	20.8%	21.2%	21.4%	21.6%	20.5%	21.2%	21.0%
Total EBIT	**4.2%**	**4.4%**	**4.4%**	**4.2%**	**5.0%**	**4.0%**	**4.7%**	**4.5%**	**4.7%**
Additional Metrics									
EBIT $ Growth	**14.1%**	**9.5%**	**4.7%**	**2.6%**	**17.7%**	**3.6%**	**7.5%**	**8.6%**	**10.0%**
Tax Rate	25.4%	24.2%	25.5%	22.9%	24.8%	24.5%	25.0%	22.8%	24.4%
EPS Growth	**5.8%**	**13.0%**	**5.8%**	**8.1%**	**18.5%**	**4.5%**	**11.0%**	**10.8%**	**13.1%**

Source: Deutsche Bank estimates, Company Filings

Takeaways from our Meetings

Consumer Resilient with Pressure Moderating

Management continues to characterize the consumer as resilient, noting that June was the toughest month as gas moved above $4/gallon which pressured spending. More recently, lower-income behavior has stabilized as consumers adjust to higher everyday costs. As a useful indicator, average gallons purchased fell below 10 in June for the first time in five years before recovering above 10 in July. While management remains mindful of prolonged fuel pressure, WMT's value proposition has historically strengthened when consumers are under pressure, supporting continued confidence in its competitive position and ability to take share.

Pricing Moving Higher, but Value Remains Intact

Higher diesel costs are beginning to flow through to pricing, but WMT's relative value position remains intact. Elevated diesel is pressuring WMT directly through transportation costs and indirectly as suppliers pass through higher costs, including on petroleum-linked products. WMT has begun raising prices across a broad set of categories, but competitors have followed quickly, allowing the company to maintain strong price gaps. **At current diesel levels, management sees roughly 50-100 bps of additional inflation in 2027** and expects incremental fuel costs to exceed the total tariff-refund benefit (e.g. $2B incremental in 2026 on top of ~$1B in fuel-related costs in the base), underscoring the magnitude of the fuel headwind.

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At the same time, rollback levels should decline in 3Q from 2Q as WMT evaluates the returns from its recent investments: some have become permanent, while others have rolled off/set to roll off or been reversed where the expected volume response did not materialize. Interestingly, elasticity has been muted in both directions, with some rollbacks generating less incremental volume than expected, while recent price increases have not resulted in the typical volume degradation.

Lastly, pricing has become more competitive in select markets, particularly against KR in Cincinnati, but WMT still sees a meaningful price advantage, both in stores and online, and has not seen evidence of share loss.

Sales: More Than Meets the Comp

Traditional retail metrics such as SSS are becoming less relevant as WMT's earnings model evolves. While in-store comps are slightly negative, the value of the stores remains clear given the volumes processed for pickup and delivery fulfillment. Management appears to view GMV as a more appropriate measure of overall performance and is considering providing disclosures that could help the investment community better contextualize share performance.

Underlying comps remain healthy despite the headline pressure from Health & Wellness. The reported U.S. comp was 2.6% in 2Q, while the underlying business excluding Health & Wellness continues to be within the ~3%-4% range. GLP-1 was roughly a 100 bps comp tailwind last year, while the IRA/MFP headwind is slightly larger this year at ~120-125 bps. Management expects this pressure to persist for roughly another six quarters before beginning to normalize. Importantly, the IRA/MFP headwind is primarily a sales issue rather than a profit issue. The 2027 impact remains uncertain given additional drugs moving under MFP and potential branded-to-generic conversions. However, WMT generates most of its pharmacy profit on generics, meaning generic conversion can actually improve the economics even as it pressures reported sales.

Digital should support structurally higher margins over time, but management remains focused on balancing margin expansion with reinvestment. Management sees the potential for all-in digital economics, including advertising, membership and fulfillment services, to ultimately eclipse traditional retail margins. As the mix shifts, higher-margin revenue streams benefit gross margin while last-mile delivery costs sit in SG&A, meaning higher expenses do not necessarily signal weaker digital economics. With operating profits up ~8.2% since 2023, when WMT introduced its framework of growing operating profit faster than sales, management still sees a long runway of high-ROI opportunities and does not want to maximize near-term margins at the expense of long-term growth.

Agentic Commerce Expands the Ecosystem

WMT is constructive on agentic commerce and believes it can participate in 3P agentic ecosystems while retaining control over its product information, advertising opportunities and owned shopping experience. Absolute agentic adoption remains relatively small; however, management views the channel as an incremental customer-acquisition opportunity. Sparky, WMT's internal agent, is an important proof point, with users generating ~40% higher average order values. Agentic traffic also converts at high rates, as queries tend to reflect more specific shopping missions. Looking externally, management does not believe it



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needs to limit the number of agentic partners, expecting the ecosystem to consolidate naturally over time.

More important is retaining merchant-of-record status, first-party customer data and advertising rights. WMT provides external agents with product information such as price, availability and delivery speed, while customer purchase history remains proprietary. Shared data is also sandboxed so it cannot be used to auction WMT's offer against competitors.

WMT does not currently see agentic commerce as a threat to the advertising algorithm, although some channel shift could occur. Transactions completed through another channel could result in lost advertising revenue, but current volumes remain small enough to manage. Longer term, management sees the potential for agentic advertising to be more valuable per impression, as narrowly defined shopping missions provide stronger intent signals than conventional search. This could translate into lower ad loads but higher-value inventory and CPMs, with vendors competing for placement across a narrower set of relevant products.

Importantly, management believes the economics can be attractive for both WMT and the agent provider. WMT retains the sale and customer transaction, while the agent provider benefits from the learning and model training generated through a successful commerce outcome. This creates value on both sides without requiring WMT to give up ownership of its most valuable first-party customer data or advertising assets.

Other Interesting Topics

Marketplace: Marketplace remains an important avenue to grow GM with less inventory and markdown risk. General merchandise growth is increasingly coming through Marketplace, with ~50%-55% of Marketplace concentrated in apparel and home, where assortment breadth matters. Unlike 1P, 3P allows WMT to earn a commission without taking inventory, seasonal or markdown risk, while also creating opportunities for advertising and Walmart Fulfillment Services. Management is using lost-sales or "leakage" data to identify brands and categories customers are buying elsewhere and use Marketplace to capture more of that spend. WMT has identified ~300-400 priority brands and currently carries roughly half, leaving meaningful assortment whitespace.

Membership: Membership remains significantly underpenetrated, with the value increasingly extending beyond the membership fee. Management sees no reason the combined platforms cannot ultimately reach ~100M members. Additionally, management believes it can materially improve the value proposition using capabilities WMT already has, providing additional runway without requiring significant new investment. Consistent with prior commentary, management increasingly views the incremental GMV generated by members as more important than the membership fee itself.

Automation: Automation is only about halfway through its journey, leaving meaningful productivity upside ahead. Over 50% of e-commerce fulfillment is automated today, but management stressed that the financial benefits are not linear. Savings compound as automation reaches greater scale and enables WMT to remove additional costs across the network, suggesting productivity benefits should continue to build as the rollout progresses.

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Last-mile: Last-mile speed remains a competitive advantage, but management believes it can expand methodically rather than chase speed at any cost. WMT can currently reach ~60% of the U.S. population within 30 minutes and ~95% within three hours, while management noted that each day removed from delivery time can improve conversion by ~30%. The company is also evaluating ways to address urban whitespace by applying lessons from international markets, including inventory clouds around stores used in China and webbed-node approaches in India. Management does not expect the U.S. to replicate the ultra-fast models of either market, but believes WMT's global footprint allows it to test and transfer successful capabilities into U.S. cities where its physical presence is more limited. Importantly, the required investments are contemplated within the current CapEx framework.

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Appendix 1

Important Disclosures

Company	Ticker	Recent price	Disclosure
Walmart Inc	WMT.OQ	116.16 (USD) 14 Oct 26	2, 14, 24

Prices are current as of the end of the previous trading session unless otherwise indicated and are sourced from local exchanges via Reuters, Bloomberg and other vendors. Other information is sourced from Deutsche Bank, subject companies, and other sources.

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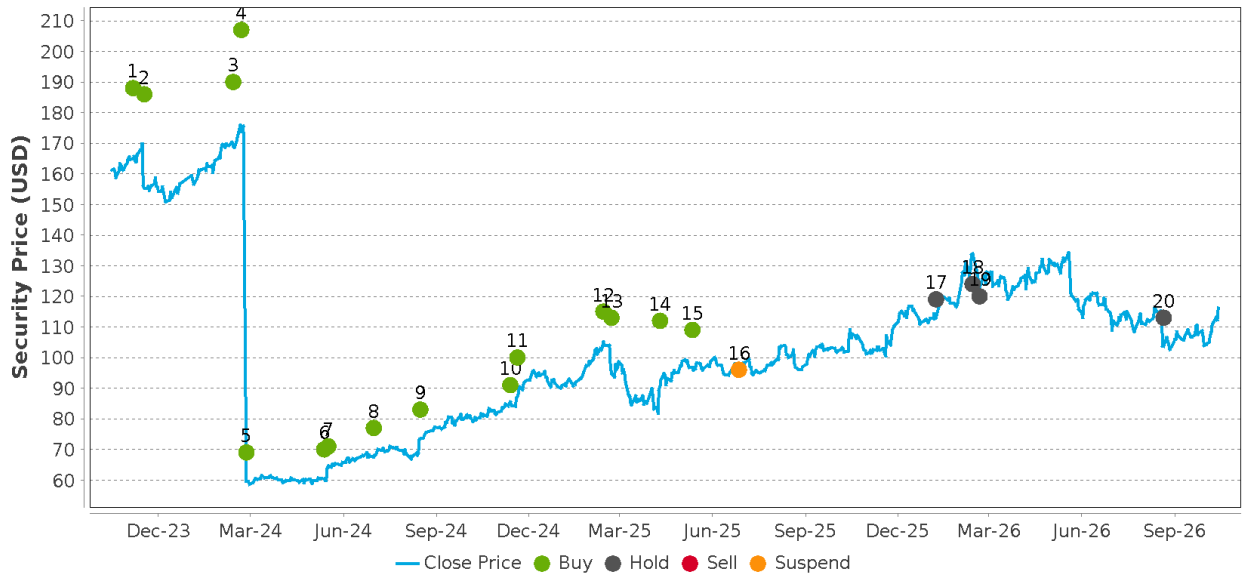
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Historical recommendations and target price: Walmart Inc (WMT.OQ)



1.	6 Nov 23	Price target: 188 (USD), close price 164.88 (USD), Recommendation: Buy, Analyst: Krisztina Katai
2.	17 Nov 23	Price target: 186 (USD), close price 155.35 (USD), Recommendation: Buy, Analyst: Krisztina Katai
3.	13 Feb 24	Price target: 190 (USD), close price 169.14 (USD), Recommendation: Buy, Analyst: Krisztina Katai
4.	21 Feb 24	Price target: 207 (USD), close price 173.7 (USD), Recommendation: Buy, Analyst: Krisztina Katai
5.	26 Feb 24	Price target: 69 (USD), close price 59.6 (USD), Recommendation: Buy, Analyst: Krisztina Katai
6.	13 May 24	Price target: 70 (USD), close price 60.41 (USD), Recommendation: Buy, Analyst: Krisztina Katai
7.	17 May 24	Price target: 71 (USD), close price 64.65 (USD), Recommendation: Buy, Analyst: Krisztina Katai
8.	1 Jul 24	Price target: 77 (USD), close price 67.48 (USD), Recommendation: Buy, Analyst: Krisztina Katai
9.	16 Aug 24	Price target: 83 (USD), close price 73.45 (USD), Recommendation: Buy, Analyst: Krisztina Katai
10.	13 Nov 24	Price target: 91 (USD), close price 85.5 (USD), Recommendation: Buy, Analyst: Krisztina Katai
11.	20 Nov 24	Price target: 100 (USD), close price 87.18 (USD), Recommendation: Buy, Analyst: Krisztina Katai
12.	13 Feb 25	Price target: 115 (USD), close price 105.05 (USD), Recommendation: Buy, Analyst: Krisztina Katai
13.	21 Feb 25	Price target: 113 (USD), close price 94.78 (USD), Recommendation: Buy, Analyst: Krisztina Katai
14.	10 Apr 25	Price target: 112 (USD), close price 90.61 (USD), Recommendation: Buy, Analyst: Krisztina Katai
15.	12 May 25	Price target: 109 (USD), close price 96.75 (USD), Recommendation: Buy, Analyst: Krisztina Katai
16.	27 Jun 25	Coverage suspended

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17.	8 Jan 26	Price target: 119 (USD), close price 113.07 (USD), Recommendation: Hold, Analyst: Krisztina Katai
18.	13 Feb 26	Price target: 124 (USD), close price 133.89 (USD), Recommendation: Hold, Analyst: Krisztina Katai
19.	20 Feb 26	Price target: 120 (USD), close price 122.99 (USD), Recommendation: Hold, Analyst: Krisztina Katai
20.	21 Aug 26	Price target: 113 (USD), close price 103.7 (USD), Recommendation: Hold, Analyst: Krisztina Katai

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Company rating dispersion and banking relationships

DBSI Companies under Coverage	Buy	Hold	Sell
Covered	58%	42%	0%
w/ Banking relationship	43%	34%	0%
w/ MiFID services	63%	52%	67%

Global Companies under Coverage	Buy	Hold	Sell
Covered	58%	40%	2%
w/ Banking relationship	46%	32%	26%
w/ MiFID services	74%	67%	90%

Company Rating and Dispersion Key

The above table provides a snapshot of Deutsche Bank's company research rating distribution across our covered companies. We also present the percentage of companies where Deutsche Bank has provided Investment Banking Services in the past 12 months and/or MIFID Investment and Ancillary services, in the past 12 months. Please see the key and definition of our rating below.

Note - percentages are rounded so may not total 100%.

Covered: The overall rating distribution across all companies under coverage with a rating.

w/Banking relation: Percentage of companies under coverage with a rating within each of the "buy", "hold" and "sell" categories for which Deutsche Bank has provided Investment Banking Services within the previous 12 months.

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Rating definitions:

Buy: Based on a current 12-month view of TSR, we recommend that investors buy the stock.

Sell: Based on a current 12-month view of TSR, we recommend that investors sell the stock.

Hold: We take a neutral view on the stock 12-months out and, based on this time horizon, do not recommend either a Buy or Sell.

TSR: Total Shareholder Return. Percentage change in share price from current price to projected target price plus projected dividend yield.

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